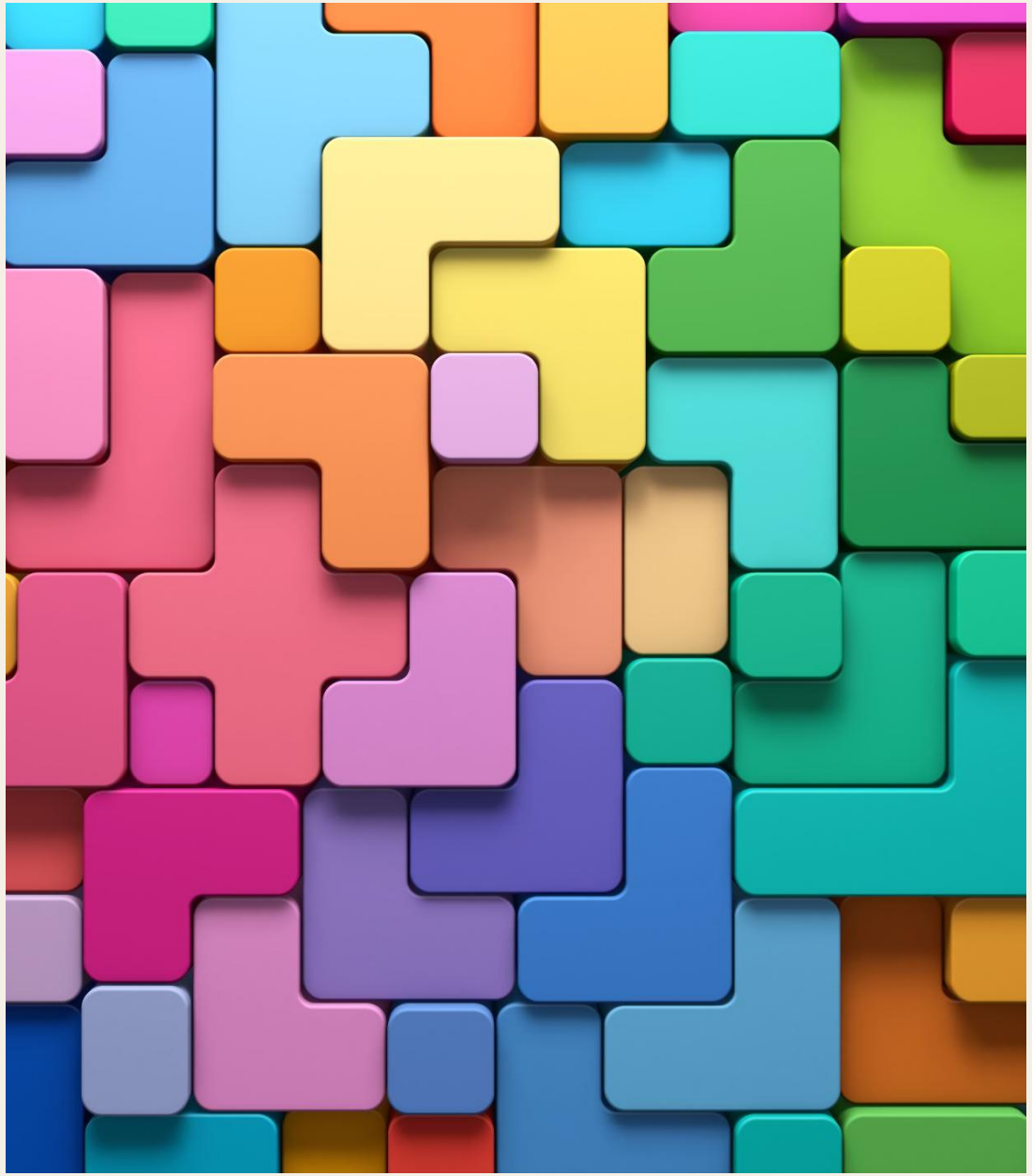
RACHEL KERRIGAN, PHD

JANUARY 15, 2026

WELCOME TO PROFESSIONAL ORIENTATION LAW AND ETHICS



WELCOME BACK!

AGENDA

- Internship questions
- Syllabus review
- Activity
- Chapter 2- Professional Counseling Identity
- Chapter 1- Introduction to Ethics

INTERNSHIP: START APPLYING!

INTERNSHIP FAIR IS NEXT WEEK BEFORE CLASS

REQUIRED TEXTS/ RESOURCES FOR THIS CLASS

- Remley, T. P., & Herlihy, B. P. (2024). Ethical, Legal, and Professional Issues in Counseling (7th edition). Pearson. ISBN-13: 9780138168094

*****Note helpful appendixes***Lecture material comes primarily from Remley & Herlihy (2024)**

Newkrug, E. (2022) A Brief Orientation to Counseling Professional Identity, History, and Standards (Third Edition). Cognella. (optional)

- Articles/chapters on Discovery to read before class
- Integration texts (Hamman, 2025; Watson 2019)

Helpful links:

- ACA Ethical Standards- https://www.counseling.org/resources/aca-code-of-ethics.pdf (Appendix A) Note: The new code is expected to be **adopted in March 2026** and will become the new official standard at that time
- WA state Laws for counselors- https://apps.leg.wa.gov/WAC/default.aspx?cite=246-810
- CCS-R Part 2: Counselor Dispositions and Behaviors: https://www.dropbox.com/s/znws845la5yavu7/Appendix%20F%20-%20CCS-R.pdf?dl=0

SYLLABUS-KEY DATES

Class Schedule: 6pm-10pm on **Thursdays** on the following dates

January 15, January 22, January 29, February 12, February 19, March 12, March 26, April 16

Due:

- Professional communication practice: Jan 22
- Personal Informed Consent Document: Jan 29
- Online Trainings (2): Feb 12
- Quizzes in class: Feb 19, and April 16

Quizzes will be open notes but done independently

- One Paper: March 12
- Written exam-written response to a vignette: March 26th

CLASS PARTICIPATION

10 points per class. Discussion and group work is a big part of this class. One class may be missed if needed but participation points cannot be made up. Missing a second class requires a doctor’s note. Contact me for details.

CLASS 2

PROFESSIONAL COMMUNICATION

- Write a template for a letter to a clinical training site where you are interested in completing your practicum and internship. Demonstrate professionalism and a clear counselor identity in your communication. Limit the letter to three paragraphs. You may choose between:
- Writing a letter to a site where you would like to apply, expressing interest in the site, your time frame (one year of clinical training from April-April), a bit about yourself, your availability and how they can contact you.
- Writing a thank-you letter after an interview (what you appreciated about the site and why you would be good fit).

CLASS 3

INFORMED CONSENT

- Develop a personalized informed consent document applicable for use in clinical training. Bring rough drafts of your document to class #3 (due 1/31). At a minimum, please include the following:
- Purposes, goals, techniques, procedures, limitations, and potential risks and benefits of services
- Your qualifications (counseling student under supervision with a licensed professional)
- Information about termination and referrals
- Emergency protocols and crisis resources
- The role of technology
- The implications of the diagnosis and intended use of testing and reports
- Fees and billing information
- Confidentiality and its limitations
- The right to obtain records and actively participate in ongoing counseling plans
- The right to refuse recommended services or modality change and be advised of the consequences of refusal

Site it if you use a template or an example, examples in your text (Appendix B)

CLASS 4

ONLINE TRAININGS: (DUE 2/14)

- **Mandatory reporting:** https://risewiththealliance.org/programs/development-and-support-for-caregivers/mandatory-reporter/
- **Telehealth:** https://nrtrc.catalog.instructure.com/courses/washington-state-healthcare-professional-telemedicine-training(note: the Northwest Regional Telehealth Resource Center (NRTRC) provides this training, and you will need to create a NRTRC account to complete the training. It takes only 30 minutes, and it is free)
  - Washington state required clinicians to have training in Telehealth to conduct sessions online. This certificate is required for Practicum. Please keep a copy of this certificate for your records.

CLASS 5 & 8

QUIZZES

<u>Class 5 and 8</u>

Open notes/open book

Multiple choice/T/F questions

Quiz 1-covering chapters 1-8

Quiz 2-Covering chapters 9-16

Each quiz will be worth 80 points

Independent work, no internet searches, no collaboration with classmates

CLASS 6

PRINCIPLES PAPER

Code of Ethics Principle Paper (due March 14)– 140 points

Choose one of the six ethical principles outlined in the American Counseling Association's (ACA) code of ethics (autonomy, nonmaleficence, beneficence, justice, fidelity or veracity) and research the principle in depth in three ways. The code of ethics should follow APA style formatting and be 6-8 pages in length.

1. **Explore the identified ethical principle within the counseling field.** ▪ Why is the ethical principle foundational to counseling? Consider the history of this principle within the field (look for evidence in counseling theory, counselor identity and/or development of counseling). Offer two references. ▪ Identify other mental health ethical codes *(ie Psychology, MFT, Social Work, Medicine*) that consider this principle. Offer two references. ▪ What does current counseling literature say about this principle? Consider work with diverse populations. Offer at least one reference.

2. **Explain how ACA standards reflect the principle you researched.** ▪ Identify three standards from the ACA code of ethics and explain how the principle you have researched is reflected in each of the standards. Put the standards in your own words and consider how you will put them to practice in your work. • Consider at least 2 subpoints in each identified standard ▪ Each student must include a standard from section H: Distance Counseling, Technology and Social Media

3. **Explore the ethical principle from a Christian perspective.** ▪ Which Christian virtue/virtues relate to the ethical principle? ▪ What does Christian doctrine teach on this principle? Include at two biblical references. ▪ Include one example of the virtue within church history or tradition. ▪ Identify a personal practice that may aid in developing this principle or virtue for a clinician.

CLASS 7

WRITTEN EXAM

In class, March 26th. A passing score on this exam (80% or above) is required (KPI #1)

Each student will be given a case vignette related to legal and ethical counseling issues. The student will have two hours to complete a written response to the case study where they must:

1. Identify any legal issues

2. Identify any ethical issues

3. Identify law or ACA ethical codes that address the issues in the case and how they are relevant

4. In light of the legal and ethical issues, outline 3-5 clinical steps (short term and long term) they plan to take the client through during their sessions.

5. Discuss what outside agencies/resources should be included or offered to the client to address legal and ethical issues in the short-term and long-term.

Students will **not be allowed to consult resources or notes** when taking this exam. This exam is used as a key performance indicator for student proficiency in Professional Counseling Orientation and Ethical Practice.

50 points

Class	*Item*	*Point Value*
2	Professional Communication	10
3	Informed Consent Document	50
4	Telehealth Training	5
4	Mandatory Reporting Training	5
5, 8	Two Quizzes (80 each)	160
6	Code of Ethics Paper	140
7	Written Exam (KPI)	50
All classes	Class Participation (10 points/class)	80
		Total: 500

GRADE POINTS

A Harvard grant study recently suggested which characteristic is most important for a happy life?

(Waldinger & Schulz, 2023)

Warm connections

BASED ON THEIR REVIEW OF THE RESEARCH HEATHER & ASHLEY HOLLEMAN SUGGESTED THE FOLLOWING...IN YOUR CONVERSATIONS

- Be Curious
- Believe the Best
- Express Concern
- Share your life

- See https://heatherholleman.com/about/

PHILIPPIANS 1:3-4

Do nothing out of selfish ambition or vain conceit. Rather, in humility value others above yourselves, not looking to your own interests but each of you to the interests of the others.

THINK ABOUT THE FOLLOWING AREAS IN YOUR CONVERSATIONS

- Social
- Emotional
- Physical
- Cognitive
- Volitional (decisions)
- Spiritual

The Six Conversations, Holleman, 2022

BREAK QUESTIONS

- Instead of how was your break:
- Who did you spend time with?
- What was a highlight of your break?
- How did you decide to go there?
- How did your body handle the holiday?
- Did you practice any meaningful spiritual practice?

I AM SO CURIOUS; CAN YOU TELL ME ABOUT...

CHAPTER 2
THE EXCITING FIELD OF COUNSELING!

COUNSELING IS THE PRIMARY FOCUS OF A COUNSELING DEGREE

BRIEF HISTORY

Counseling Psychology initially recognized individuals with a MA degree as professional psychologists. When licensure requirements changed to only allow those with a doctoral degree to become licensed, individuals with a MA in Psychology sought licenses in counseling.

School accreditation groups in the 60's began requiring schools to hire counselors. Almost all states now require that school counselors have a master's degree and have completed courses in internship etc.

In the 1950's vocational rehab was growing to serve those with physical and mental disabilities

Counseling is established now as a legitimate separate and unique profession with its own accreditation process, licensure, associations, conferences, journals etc.

Currently: growth of counseling-in schools, churches, community settings etc

“Counseling is a professional relationship that empowers diverse individuals, families, and groups to accomplish mental health, wellness, education, and career goals.”

“20/20: A Vision for the Future of Counseling programs was created to develop a strategic plan for the growth and sustainability of the counseling profession...involving 31 major counseling organizations...The delegates met at the ACA Conference in Pittsburgh in **March 2010** and agreed on a unified definition of counseling…The definition was then submitted to the leaders of the participating organizations, and was approved by 29 of the organizations. Details in jcd-july 2014 article by david M. Kaplan, et. al”

-20-20-a-vision-for-the-future-of-counseling/consensus-definition-of-counseling

CONSENSUS DEFINITION ACCEPTED BY

- American College Counseling Association
- American Counseling Association (ACA)
- American Mental Health Counselors Association
- American Rehabilitation Counseling Association
- Association for Adult Development and Aging
- Association for Assessment in Counseling and Education
- Association for Counselor Education and Supervision
- Association for Creativity in Counseling
- Association for Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual and Transgender Issues in Counseling
- Association for Multicultural Counseling and Development
- Association for Specialists in Group Work
- Association for Spiritual, Ethical, and Religious Values in Counseling
- Commission on Rehabilitation Counselor Certification
- Council for Accreditation of Counseling and Related
- International Association of Addictions and Offender
- Counselors
- International Association of Marriage and Family
- Counselors
- National Board for Certified Counselors
- • National Career Development Association
- • National Employment Counseling Association
- • National Rehabilitation Counseling Association

(Only School Counselors and Counselors for Social Justice did not accept the definition at the time)

CACREP SPECIALTIES: ALL STUDENTS MUST ENROLL IN ONE SPECIALIZED AREA

- Addiction Counseling
- College Counseling and Student Affairs
- Career Counseling
- Marriage, Couple and Family Counseling
- Clinical Mental Health Counseling
- School Counseling
- Rehabilitation Counseling

OTHER MENTAL HEALTH PROFESSIONS

See pg. 58-59 for detailed description of the differences between mental health providers

Psychiatrist –MD required; medical physicians trained in the medical model. RX ability

Clinical Psychologist-PhD required. Trained in Psychology, medical model. More emphasis in biological and social aspects of behavior, assessment, data analysis, measurement dx, research and psychopathology .

Clinical Social Worker- MA required. Focus on diversity, human rights, social and economic justice, policy, organizations and community health.

FOCUS OF COUNSELING:

THE WELLNESS MODEL: ACCOMPLISH WELLNESS, NOT CURE ILLNESS

- In the illness or medical model, the first thing a professional does is diagnose a client's mental or emotional disorder. Once the disorder has been treated successfully, the client is discharged until another disorder appears. Then the client returns to the professional again for treatment

- The wellness model of mental health is founded on the following beliefs:
  - The best perspective for assisting individuals in resolving their emotional and personal issues and problems. Assumes Health.
  - Most of the issues and problems individuals face in life are **developmental** in nature and, thus, understanding the dynamics of human growth and development is essential to success as a helping professional.
  - **Prevention and early intervention are superior** to remediation in dealing with personal and emotional problems.
  - The goal of counseling is to empower individuals to resolve their own problems, **independently** of mental health professionals, and to teach them to identify and resolve problems autonomously in the future.

FOCUS OF COUNSELING:

A DEVELOPMENTAL PERSPECTIVE

- People's stories are considered in the context of *lifespan*
- Understanding developmental stages can clue us into looking for areas where there is stagnation/delay and offer vision for growth
- Before offering a dx a counselor considers whether a behavior developmentally aligns with the client's progress (see examples on p. 33).
- With a partner brainstorm examples that you might see in practice where a developmental perspective would be helpful to consider.

FOCUS OF COUNSELING:

PREVENTION AND EARLY INTERVENTION

- Focus and preference for prevention rather than remediation.
- Look for areas where things are going well
- Early intervention to prevent future challenges
- Seek counseling early
- Normalize mental health, encouraging families and individuals to seek counseling before a crisis.
- Identifying positive traits, practices, strengths

FOCUS OF COUNSELING:

INDIVIDUAL EMPOWERMENT

- Empower clients to solve their problems independently
- Because our field focuses so much on cultural competency it is essential for each client to identify and utilize the cultural framework and values that are important to them in order to solve their problems.
- The primary message to clients is “you are capable of developing the skills you need for independent living and wellness” (p. 34)

ALL COUNSELING STUDENTS MUST STUDY THE FOLLOWING CORE AREAS

WHICH AREAS HAVE YOU LEARNED ABOUT SO FAR?

- Professional Orientation and Ethical Practice
- Social and Cultural Identities and Experiences
- Lifespan Development
- Career Development
- Counseling Practice and Relationships
- Group Counseling and Group Work
- Assessment and Diagnostic Processes
- Research and Program Evaluation

WHAT STANDS OUT TO YOU ABOUT THE **COUNSELING** FIELD?

PRACTICE RESPONDING TO THE FOLLOWING QUESTION FROM FRIENDS OR RELATIVES:

WHAT YOU ARE STUDYING

DEFINING COUNSELING?

- Defining counseling as a profession that is similar to another profession, such as psychology or social work, is not helpful in educating the public about the profession of counseling…or in helping counselors establish our unique professional identity.
- It would be best to explain that you are earning a master's degree in counseling, which is a professional degree that allows graduates to provide professional counseling and mental health services to the public.
- It would also be appropriate to explain the orientation of the profession focuses on **wellness, prevention, early intervention, empowerment, and lifespan development.**
- **Terminal degree for licensure is a MASTER'S DEGREE**

COMMON ADDITIONAL SERVICES (BESIDES COUNSELING)

- Assessment
- Teaching
- Diagnosis
- Case management
- Advocacy

As a future counselor you should pursue membership with the ACA-www.counseling.org (student rates apply)

There are 4 regions, many divisions and state branches

Considering WACES (western division), our state branch and divisions that interest you

19 divisions (p. 48 in your text)

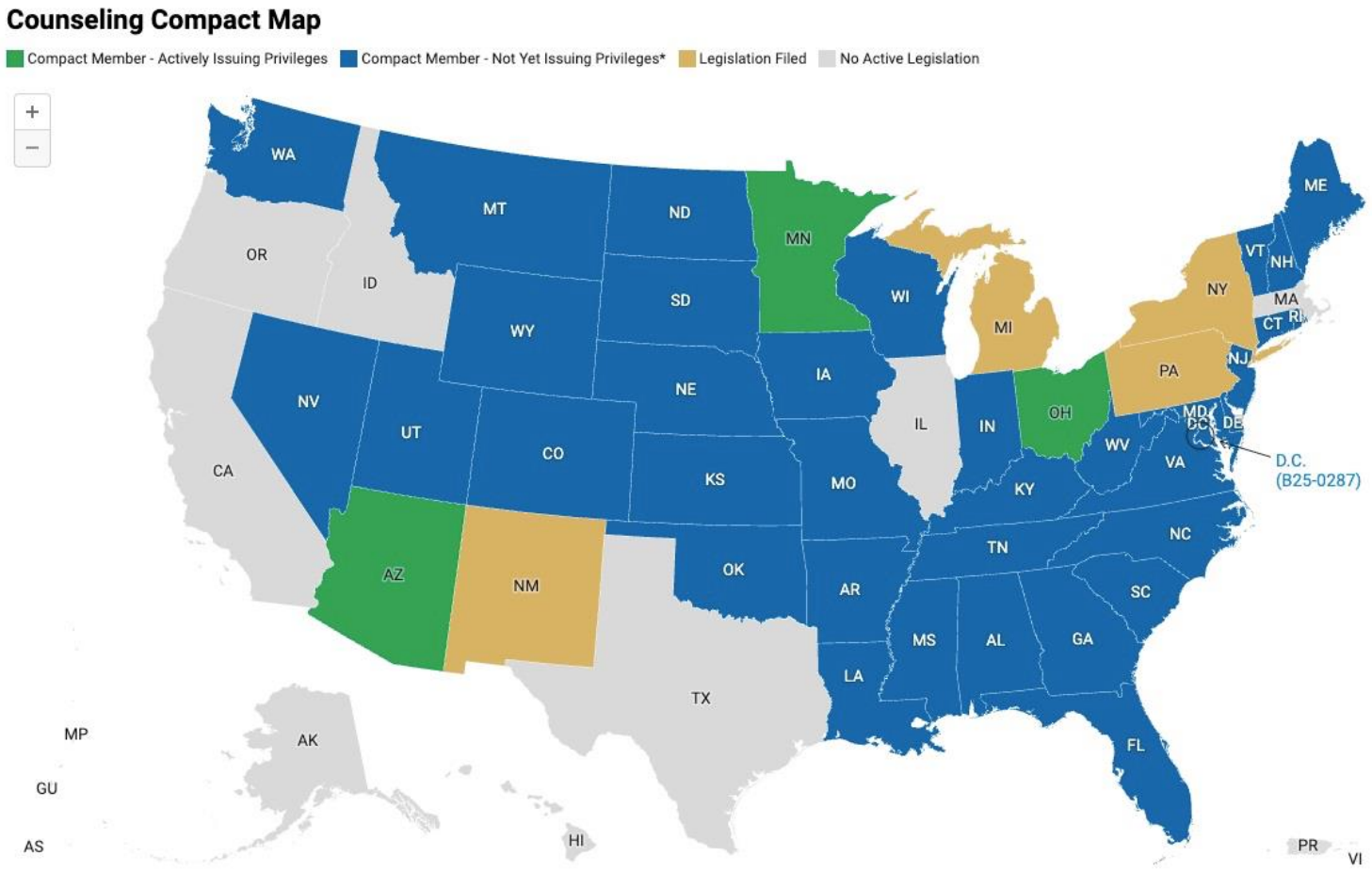
REVIEW THE 19 DIVISIONS ON PAGE 48. WHICH MIGHT YOU CONSIDER JOINING?

STATE LICENSE REQUIREMENTS VARY

- LPC
- LPC-S
- LMHC
- Clinical Counselor
- National voluntary certification
- Licensure reciprocity across states lines is a current issue in counseling

WORKING TOWARDS UNITY AND RECIPROCITY

HTTPS://COUNSELINGCOMPACT.ORG/



CACREP ACCREDITATION

- Helps with licensure portability as many states require (Ohio, Kentucky, NC, Florida) or strongly prefer counseling degrees for CACREP accredited programs
- Simplifies applications for licensure
- In WA 50 hours of postgraduate supervision and 500 hours towards postgraduate experience for LMHC licensure
- Prep for the NCE exam
- Foundation for doctoral studies
- Increased employability

CURRENT ISSUES IN COUNSELING

- Danger of fragmenting into separate groups along the lines of specialties, instead of working toward public recognition as one unified profession of counseling.
- Working toward standardization of licensure requirements and school counselor certification requirements across the 50 states, the District of Columbia, and possessions of the United States.
- Scope of practice: Ensuring that other mental health professional groups do not interfere with counselors diagnosing and treating mental and emotional disorders or limit the testing practices of counselors. Advocating for equal representation, compensation, recognition
- Establishing job classifications in state governments and at the federal level for counselors (titles at times do not include a counseling title- “social work, psychologist, metal health technician…”)
- Telehealth-Standards for practice?

MORE ISSUES TO CONSIDER

- Third party reimbursement
- Increasing salaries for MA clinicians
- Becoming united and societally-recognized as a profession
- Increasing publications of experimental research studies
- Increase availability of counseling services for everyone

DISCUSSION

What role can students play in the standardization and professionalization of counseling?

What do you believe to be the major obstacles facing the counseling profession in the 21st century?

As a future counselor, how do you see yourself advocating for the profession?

LINKS

- https://doh.wa.gov/licenses-permits-and-certificates/professions-new-renew-or-update/mental-health-counselor/supervisor-directory

- https://counselingcompact.gov/faq/

ETHICS

DEFINITIONS

Legal standards are the minimum behavior society will tolerate from a professional. Legal standards are created by society to protect citizens from bad professionals.

Ethical standards are the minimum behavior other counselors will tolerate from counselors. Ethical standards are created by counselors themselves to ensure that counselors practice in a way that helps clients and does not hurt them.

Best practice represents the ideal for counselor practice. It may be difficult to get a group of counselors to agree upon what best practice would be, but all counselors want to strive for best practice, not just meeting minimum ethical or legal standards of practice

DEFINITIONS

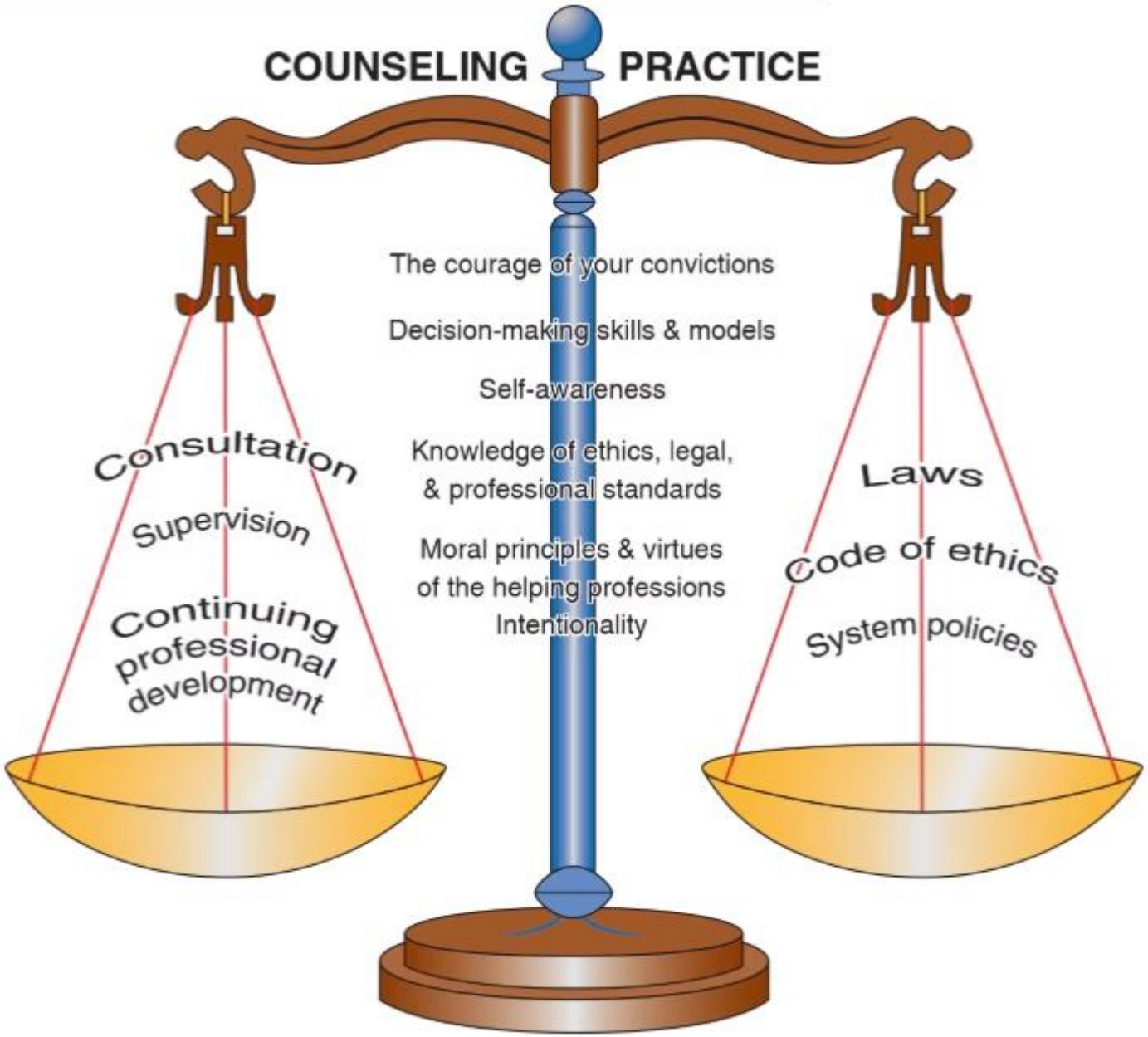
Personal Values-influenced by culture, family, community and your beliefs. Unique and important but distinct to the individual

Professional Values- identified values of a professional group

Virtue Ethics-character traits of an individual

Principle Ethics-agreed upon assumptions or beliefs shared by members of a professional group

PROFESSIONAL PRACTICE: "BUILT FROM WITHIN BUT BALANCED FROM OUTSIDE OF THE SELF" (P. 8)



Personal Values

- Apply broadly to both the personal and professional functioning of counselors
- Serve as a guide to determining what is good or right behavior
- Each of us holds some values more strongly than other values
- Each value system is unique and is influenced by upbringing, culture, and religious beliefs
- In counseling we are asked not to impose our values, rather help the client live out their own. It is critical that we know and understand our own values and practice bracketing (see case of Carole on p. 4).

PROFESSIONAL VALUES

- What comes to mind when you think of values of the following groups/companies:
- US Army
- Red Cross
- Amnesty International
- Culinary arts (American culinary federation)
- Interior Design
- Landscape
- Museums

PROFESSIONAL VALUES OF COUNSELING (ACA, 2014)

Enhancing	Enhancing human development across the lifespan
Honoring	Honoring diversity
Embracing	Embracing a multicultural approach
Promoting	Promoting social justice
Safeguarding	Safeguarding the integrity of the counselor-client relationship
Practicing	Practicing competently and ethically

Ethics

- **Ethics:** a discipline within philosophy that is concerned with human conduct and moral decision making.
- Professional ethics refers to conduct judged as good or right for counselors as a professional group.
- Consensus about right behaviors have been codified and have become the ethical standards to which counselors are expected to adhere in their professional life.
- Thus, ethics should guide one's *professional* behavior and interactions.

Theories of Ethics

- Ethical theories provide a framework that counselors can use to decide whether an action or contemplated action is ethical.
- Ascribing to an ethical theory will enable you to resolve various ethical dilemmas you encounter in your work and help you defend the solutions you reach.
- Principle Ethics in a field answer the question “what should I do”

WHY ETHICAL THEORIES ARE IMPORTANT

Ethical theories provide a framework that counselors can use to decide whether an action or contemplated action is ethical

Enable clinicians to resolve ethical dilemmas

The counseling profession has a written code of ethics. The code's guidelines for practice must be read and understood. Simply acting as you think is right and moral may not lead to your being compliance with the American Counseling Association Code of Ethics (or other counseling codes, as well).

Although counselors often have good intentions, if they violate an ethical principle or a law, they can get into serious trouble.

Theories of ethics have existed for centuries and provide a foundation for the ethical reasoning of contemporary professional counselors.

PRINCIPLE ETHICS IN COUNSELING (ACA 2014)

autonomy

nonmaleficence

beneficence

justice

fidelity

veracity

REVIEW COUNSELING'S PRINCIPLE ETHICS ON PAGES 12-13

- Define the principles
- Review the case of Gabriella considering the principle ethics. Which Ethical principles come into play?
- What other ways might these principles might come into play in a counseling relationship

Why a Code of Ethics?

- Educate members of the profession as well as consumers about what constitutes ethical practice
- Help to ensure accountability through enforcement of the standards
- Protect the profession from government by allowing the profession to regulate itself and function more autonomously
- Promote stability within the profession by establishing agreed-upon guidelines for practice
- Serve as a catalyst for ongoing improvement of practice

EXAMPLES OF ETHICAL CODES

- ACA: Ethical Standards
- AACC ethical standards-https://aacc.net/wp-content/uploads/2023/10/AACC_Code-of-Ethics-2023_FINAL.pdf
- Ethical Guidelines for Counseling Supervisors
- Code of Ethics of the American Mental Health Counselors Association Ethical Standards for School Counselors
- AAMFT Code of Ethics
- Ethical Principles of Psychologists and Code of Conduct Ethical Standards of Human Service Professionals
- Ethics of the International Association of Marriage and Family Counselors Code of Ethics of the National Association of Social Workers
- Canadian Counselling Association Code of Ethics
- Code of Professional Ethics for Rehabilitation Counselors National Board for Certified Counselors Code of Ethics.
- NBCC Standards for the Ethical Practice of Internet Counseling
- Association for the Specialists in Group Work Professional Standards for the Training of Group Workers.
- Association for the Specialists in Group Work Best Practice Guidelines
- Association for the Specialists in Group Work Principles for Diversity-Competent Group. Workers

THE ACA CODE INCLUDES

- Preamble
- 8 sections (A-I)
  - The Counseling Relationship
  - Confidentiality and Privacy
  - Professional Responsibility
  - Relationships with Pther Professionals
- Evaluation, Assessment and Interpretation
- Supervision Training and Teaching
- Research and Publication
- Distance Counseling, Technology and Social Media
- Resolving Ethical Issues

Principles Ethics vs Virtue Ethics

- ***Principle ethics*** refer to the professionally agreed upon obligations that are always considered in ethical decision making.
- Principle ethics ask: “What should I do?”
- ***Virtue ethics*** assume that professional ethics involve more than moral actions; they also involve traits of character or virtue.
- Virtue ethics ask: “Who should I be?”

VIRTUE ETHICS

- Beyond moral actions, virtue ethics looks at character, virtue ethics asks “Who should I be”, not just as a clinician but as a person. The focus is on YOU as a person, not a particular action or decision.

A. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kq-rOelLciE

- Virtue ethics asks us to consider virtue OVER what emotion dictates, what is financially beneficial, the easiest solution.
- People have different strengths of character and should aim to express the virtues most important to them

CIGAR

TO PREPARE FOR NEXT CLASS:

FREE CHARACTER STRENGTH'S TEST:
HTTPS://WWW.VIACHARACTER.ORG/

Legal Issues

- Most areas of counselor practice are affected by law
- Counselors must know how to recognize legal issues and how to obtain legal advice
- Counselors should:
  - seek advice from fellow mental health professionals when they have clinical or ethical questions
  - seek advice from lawyers when they have legal questions
- Following laws typically represents minimum requirement

YOU ARE NOT ALONE! SUPPORT STRUCTURES OFFER GUIDANCE AND SUPPORT

Consultation

Supervision

Continuing professional development

Laws

Code of Ethics

System policies

HOW SHOULD YOU GET ADVICE WHEN A LEGAL ISSUE PRESENTS ITSELF?

Generally, counselors should ask their immediate supervisor to obtain legal advice for them. The supervisor then obtains the advice and reports it to the counselor.

The ACA professional liability insurance company provides a legal *hot line* that insured counselors can call and talk to an attorney free of charge.

Counselors employed in an agency do not need to pay for legal advice themselves. The only exception would be if the agency is planning to take adverse action against the counselor because of the legal problem. Under those circumstances, a counselor should hire his or her own lawyer.

STEPS IN MAKING ETHICAL DECISIONS

- A general eight-step process for ethical decision making. Keep in mind cultural context and your emotions.
  1. **Identify the problem or dilemma-**Is it a legal issue or a clinical issue? Take time to review the situation carefully. (example-termination/leave p. 23)
  2. **Involve your client in the decision-making process** - Throughout the process, involve your client, this empowers the client and builds the relationship with your client (part of safeguarding the integrity of the counselor. (example p. 9)
  3. **Review the relevant ethics codes** -Review codes, laws and literature
  4. **Consider the principles and virtues**. Consider not just what to DO but who you want to BE in the situation

STEPS CONTINUED

5. **Tune into your feelings**-consider the emotions you are experiencing. Do you have fear/doubt? Do you feel you are being influenced by others in a direction you don't agree with? Be aware of emotions, beliefs, values and motivations at play. *It is important that your body is relaxed and your mind is engaged throughout this process. Tend to your reaction and take steps to relax and engage.*
6. **CONSULT with colleagues or experts-**Emotions can interfere. Obtain consultation. This is important from a legal standpoint as well.
7. **Consider the context**-Be culturally competent. What ramifications might there be for the client's family, community, other professionals etc.
8. **Make a decision and act on your choice-**Don't linger in indecision. Have courage to come to a decision and act it out.

ACTIVITY

- Apply the ethical decision model on pages 12-13 to the scenarios in the text. At this point focus particularly on considering the 6-principle ethics in counseling, which of the 6 principle ethics come into play in making a decision?
  - case 1-1, p. 4
  - case 1-2, p. 6
  - case 1-3, p. 11
  - case 1-4, p. 13
  - case 1-5., p. 25

DISCUSSION

Assuming that you are a moral and responsible person (as are most counselors), why do you think it is important for you to study ethical and legal principles and the decision-making process?